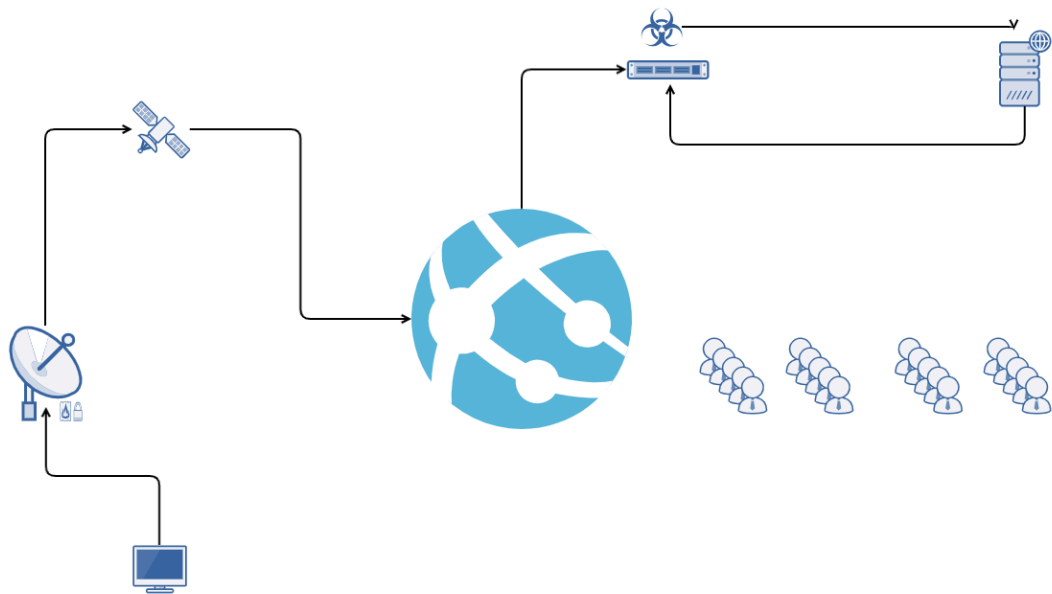


A FAILED WEB STACK



Issue Summary

For 20 minutes Between 12:00 pm and 12:20 pm GMT+1 on Wednesday, 1st of May 2024, all request sent to the domain “victory-chibuike.tech” was returned with a site not reachable response, this did not affect and user but it affected me as I was trying to test my new configuration. The reason for this outage was a bad block of configuration instruction that I had just updated into the configuration file for the nginx server

Timeline (all times GMT+1)

- 12:00 PM: I queried the site using a Chrome client and it was unreachable
- 12:01 PM: I used a command line client curl to query the raw ip of the machine
- 12:02 PM: SSH into server and began debugging
- 12:05 PM: used systemctl to discover the server was not running
- 12:12 PM: Cause of issue discovered, a bad configuration file

- 12:14 PM: snipped out the wrong block of code
- 12:18 PM: Solution provided
- 12:20 PM: Server set up and running again

Root Cause and Resolution

I had initially used sed to insert a block of text after a certain string into the configuration file. The first time I ran this command everything went well and my server was up, but after some days, on the 1st of May I wanted to reinitialize everything and I ran the command again, since it was in a script with other important commands. This 2nd iteration created a duplicate of that block of text and resulted in a syntax error for an nginx configuration file so the server refused to start.

I resolved the issue by deleting one block and leaving the other duplicate and then started the server afresh

Corrective and Preventive Measure

- When using sed in a script always use a condition that says if your choice of text already exists, no action should be performed
- Always test the server in an ssh session before login out
- TODO: Update that script to meet point one demand
- TODO: Document a details explanation of how the issue was resolved
- TODO: Add an image to this document